

PHENIX REBIRTH

Player Manual

Version 1.1.0 · English · Free to play · Open source · MIT

1. About

Phenix Rebirth is a modern PC remake of the arcade shooter *Phoenix* (1978 / 1980). Stage cycle, boss saucer, signature **PHENIX** mode, keyboard and gamepad, 13 languages. Since 1.1.0: solo, hot seat and simultaneous coop.

Unofficial fan project. Not an official port of Amstar Electronics, Centuri or Taito.

2. Install

Requires Python 3.10+ and Pygame 2.5+.

Windows: double-click **lancer.bat** (installs Pygame if needed).

```
git clone https://github.com/Kraran/PhenixRebirth.git
cd PhenixRebirth
python -m pip install -r requirements.txt
python main.py
```

Optional Windows build: **build_exe.bat** (PyInstaller).

Downloads: GitHub v1.1.0 · itch.io.

3. Play modes

1 player — keyboard or gamepad from Options.

Hot seat — two players take turns. Each keeps stage, score, lives and PHENIX gauge. After a death, the game waits for a key.

Coop — two ships at once (they pass through each other). Separate scores and gauges, **5 shared lives**. Player 2 is blue-tinted (gas-blue PHENIX flames).

4. Controls

Menus — confirm: Enter, Space, Ctrl. Up: arrow, W and Z (AZERTY).

Action	1P / coop P2	Coop P1 keyboard	Gamepad
Move	Arrows	Q or A + D	Stick / D-Pad
Fire	Space / Right Ctrl	Left Ctrl	A
PHENIX	Right Shift	Left Shift	B
Pause	Esc	Esc	Start
Confirm menu	Enter / Space / fire	same	A
Back	Esc	Esc	B

Coop pad + keyboard: P1 = pad, P2 = arrows as in solo. One shot per ship on screen (two total). In PHENIX: dual flame shots per ship.

5. Stages and scoring

Stage	Enemies	Points (Normal)
1	Dark birds	10
2	Green / khaki birds	20
3	Gargoyles	30 (body only)
4	Violet / dark-red gargoyles	40
5	Saucer + escorts	Core 200 · bricks 1 · decos 50

After the boss the cycle restarts faster (stage 6 = stage 1 at +10%, and so on). Veteran: birds +10 pts, boss 300. Novice: slower enemies, 5 lives, no high-score entry, longer PHENIX. Bonus lives at 1,337 and 8,086.

Gargoyles: wings are neutral; only the body kills and scores.

6. PHENIX mode

Gauge +1 per body kill, −1 per miss. Wings, bricks and decos are neutral. From level 3: Shift / X or B. Immune to shots and bird collisions, faster, dual flames. The gauge drains as the timer. Press B / Shift again to cancel and **keep** the gauge. Short cooldown. Edge electricity empties the gauge. Boss bricks still kill you in PHENIX form.

7. Options

Main menu or pause: controls, **autofire** (On = hold to shoot again when the shot has left the screen; Off = one press = one shot), SFX / music volumes, rumble 0–5, fullscreen / window / borderless, language (13), FPS counter, scanlines 0–3, ultrawide bezel (Phenix, Tesla, Blue, Fire, Off), reset high scores. Saved in **settings.json**.

High scores: top 15, 3-letter initials. Coop scores show a two-player mark. Cheats on the high-score screen (block table entry): LVL2–LVL5, LIVE, PHEN.

8. Credits

Development: Franck Fornasari (Kraran)

Assistance: Grok — xAI

Inspiration: Phoenix (1978 / 1980) — Amstar Electronics / Centuri / Taito

Music: Phenix — Eternal Dawn, Game Over, Last Coin (Credits) — Suno

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No quarter given. No continue forever.